Muddy York Fishing

Brand guide for social media

How Muddy York Fishing looks and sounds on Instagram, Facebook, TikTok and anywhere else we post. Read the voice and checklist sections before your first post.

Who we are

Muddy York Fishing is an app for Southern Ontario trout, steelhead and salmon anglers. Every morning it ranks 30+ rivers on live water temperature, flow and weather, shows the official season for each stretch, and suggests the technique and fly for the day. Anglers can also scout rivers and creeks anywhere within their own radius.

The name comes from "Muddy York", the old nickname for Toronto. The feel is a modest members' club: deep pine green, brass, a heritage crest, and plain, knowledgeable talk about real rivers.

Who we talk to

Trout, steelhead and salmon anglers across Southern Ontario, from first-timers to lifers.

The job of social

Be the most useful river feed in Ontario, then invite people to try the app free.

The offer

7 days free, then $9.99 a month or $59.99 a year ($5.00 a month).

Where we send people

muddyyorkfishing.ca/fishing for new people. The app itself is at muddyyorkfishing.ca.

Five things we always come back to

1. Fish the right river on the right day. Conditions change daily and the app reads them for you.
2. Know what's legal before you go: official Ontario season status for every stretch.
3. Built for Southern Ontario rivers, not a generic map.
4. Your spots stay private.
5. Seven days free, then $5.00 a month on the yearly plan.

Where we're going

Today we cover Southern Ontario. The plan is to grow in this order, and every post should fit it:

1. **The most complete fishing suggestion engine for our rivers.** Beyond free public data: members' trip reports (blank days included), the run tracker, the cold-water index, Ontario's official survey and regulation data, and a score we measure against what anglers actually catch.
2. **British Columbia next.** The same engine for BC's rivers.
3. **The Maritime provinces after that.**
4. **Native Apple and Android apps** as we grow, alongside the web app.

What that means for social

- Say **Southern Ontario** for where we are today, never "near Toronto" or "within two hours of Toronto" as a limit. We cover plenty of water further out.
- Talk about the engine getting smarter: new data, new features, the score's accuracy as reports come in.
- Don't announce BC or the Maritimes, or give dates, until we're ready to launch there.
- The name stays. Muddy York is where we started; the voice and quality are what travel.

Logo

The crest (a leaping trout in a gold ring) is our mark. Pair it with the wordmark: "Muddy York" in Playfair Display with "Fishing" in brass, or "FISHING" spaced out underneath.







On pine (first choice), on bone, and on a photo darkened with a pine overlay.

Do

- Leave clear space around the crest at least as wide as the trout's tail.
- Keep the crest at least 48 px wide on screen. For a profile picture, use the crest alone.
- On photos, darken the image behind the logo so the gold ring reads.

Don't

- Recolour, outline, stretch or rotate the crest.
- Add shadows, glows or stickers on top of it.
- Put it on a busy, bright part of a photo.

Colour

Mostly bone and pine, with brass for small details. Brick red is saved for the thing we want people to tap: "Start free", "Try it free for 7 days".

Pine

Headers, backgrounds, headlines on light.

Deep pine

Dark backgrounds and photo overlays.

Bone

Page and post backgrounds.

Brass

Rules, the crest ring, small highlights.

Deep brass

Brass text on bone, where brass is too light.

Brick

Calls to action only. One per post.

Iron

Body text on bone.

Paper

Text on pine and on dark photos.



Rough balance in a post: bone 50%, pine 35%, brass 8%, brick 7%. Season tags in the app use pine for "In season", brick for "Closed" and brass for "Check regs". Keep those meanings on social too.

Type

Two typefaces, both free on Google Fonts. Playfair Display for headlines, Public Sans for everything else.

The Credit is running clear

Steelhead are in the lower river

Fresh rain on Tuesday pulled new fish in. Water is 9°C and dropping, which is prime for swinging streamers.

LOWER CREDIT, MISSISSAUGA

Use	Face	On a 1080 px post
Headline	Playfair Display, Bold or ExtraBold	80 to 110 px, one or two lines, sentence case
Supporting line	Public Sans, Regular or SemiBold	36 to 44 px
Small label (river, place)	Public Sans, Bold, small caps spacing	26 to 30 px, deep brass or paper
Numbers (scores, °C, m^3/s)	Playfair Display Bold	Big and alone, with a short label under it

Sentence case everywhere. No all-caps headlines, no more than two sizes of text on one slide.

Photography

Real Ontario water, natural light, fish shown with respect. The river is usually the hero; the angler is part of the scene.



The water itself: gorges, riffles, fall colour.



Anglers in the river, small in the frame.



Fish held low over the water, wet hands.



Underwater and close-up fish shots.

Do

- Use photos from Ontario rivers whenever possible, or ones that could pass for them.
- Ask members before reposting their catch, and credit them by @handle.
- Strip location data from photos before posting.
- Credit free-licence photos the way the licence asks (see muddyyorkfishing.ca/photo-credits).

Don't

- Show fish on gravel, grass or dry boards, or held by the gills.
- Show fish taken from closed water, or a sanctuary in the background.
- Show landmarks that give away a small creek's exact spot.
- Use generic stock: smiling models, saltwater, boats on lakes.

Voice

We sound like the most knowledgeable person at the fly shop: plain, local, honest, and careful with the resource. We sign off with "Tight lines."

Direct

Lead with the answer.

> *Chinook run the Ganaraska from late August, peaking in September.*

Not: "In this post we're going to talk about..."

Local and specific

Real river, road and town names.

> *Below the Highway 403 bridge the Credit is open all year.*

Not: lines that could be about any river anywhere.

Honest

We never promise fish.

> *Fresh rain pulls new fish in. Warm, dry spells stall the run.*

Not: "guaranteed", "never get skunked", "the best" without proof.

Respectful of the resource

Conservation and the rules come first.

> *Spawning fish need room. Watch from the bank and stay off the gravel.*

Not: anything that encourages fishing closed water or warm-water trout.

Say this, not that

Say this	Not that	Why
fish sanctuary, closed to fishing	off limits, banned	The official wording
Ontario Fishing Regulations Summary	the regs book	Official name the first time
Fisheries Management Zone 16 (FMZ 16)	area 16	Official term
steelhead (lake-run rainbow trout)	rainbows, for lake-run fish	Precision
public access	secret spot	Privacy and respect for landowners
members	users, subscribers	We're a club

Never use

~~guaranteed~~ ~~never get skunked~~ ~~secret spot~~ ~~hidden gem~~ ~~unfair advantage~~ ~~game-changer~~ ~~unlock the secrets~~ ~~em dashes (—)~~

Use commas, full stops or a new sentence instead of em dashes. Emoji are fine in moderation (🎣 🐟 🍂), never as bullet points.

Social formats



Instagram post
1080 × 1350



Reels, Stories, TikTok
1080 × 1920



Carousel slide
1080 × 1080



Facebook link
1200 × 630

On 9:16, keep text out of the top 250 px and bottom 340 px, where the app's buttons sit.

What we post

Series	What it is
River of the week	One river: what's in it, whe fishes, the official season to its river guide.
Conditions check	"This morning on the wate few rivers' conditions, screenshot from the app.
Season and rules	Openers, closures, sanctu from the official summary Always link the source.
Salmon run updates	Where the fish are, where watch, what's legal. Augus November.
Fly of the week	One pattern, the size, and water it's for.
Member catches	With permission, river nan no exact spot.
Conservation	Handling fish, cold-water stream clean-ups.



Hashtags

#MuddyYorkFishing #OntarioFishing #FlyFishingOntario #SteelheadFishing #SalmonRun #OntarioTrout #TorontoFishing #TightLines

Use 3 to 6 per post: our own, one or two broad ones, and one about the river or town.

Profile bio

Instagram bio

Ontario trout & salmon river intel 🎣
Know which river is fishing before you go.
Live conditions, official seasons, today's fly.
7 days free ⬇️

Caption templates

Swap the bracketed parts. Keep the river name, a real detail, and one clear next step.

Conditions check

This morning on the water 🌲
[River] is [condition] at [score]/100. Water [x]°C and [dropping/rising] after [weather].
[One line on what that means, e.g. "Prime for swinging streamers in the tailouts."]
Check your stretch is open before you go. Today's scores for 30+ rivers are in the app, 7 days free.
Link in bio.
Tight lines.

Season reminder

[Date]: [what opens or closes] in Fisheries Management Zone [N].
[One specific stretch that's different, e.g. "Below Highway 403 the Credit stays open all year."]
Source: Ontario Fishing Regulations Summary. The app shows today's status for your exact stretch.
Tight lines.

Salmon run update

Salmon run update, [week] 🐟
Fish are [staging off the mouth / moving / stacked below the ladder] on the [River] in [town].
Best viewing: [public spot]. Go the morning after rain.
Watching only from [landmark] to [landmark], it's a fish sanctuary until [date].
Where to watch and what's legal: muddyyorkfishing.ca/salmon-run

Member catch (with permission)

Nice fish, @[handle] 👏
[Species] from the [River] on a [fly/lure]. Released to fight another day.
Want to know when your river turns prime? Members get one alert when it happens. Link in bio.

Before you post

- [ ] The river and stretch are named correctly, and the season status matches the app today.
- [ ] No exact location: no geotag, no landmark that gives away a small creek, location data stripped.
- [ ] The fish is handled properly and from water that was open.
- [ ] No banned words, no em dashes, no promises of fish.
- [ ] One call to action, in brick if it's on the image.
- [ ] Photo credit added if it isn't ours or the member's.
- [ ] Link goes to the right page: /fishing for new people, a river or salmon-run page for river posts.

Questions or new assets: info@muddyyorkfishing.ca · Website: muddyyorkfishing.ca/fishing · Fonts: Playfair Display and Public Sans on Google Fonts.